Yarra Phanit

Resource Identifier: CULT-FEST-005

English Translation: Spring Youth Festival

Category: Festival | Subcategory: Youth

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Longshim Youths (Traditional Observation (Ruivah 1993))

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: April (Spring season of awakening and youth courting)

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Spring youth celebration celebrated within village dormitories (Longshim) featuring feasting, folk song exchanges, and socialization among youth.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Yarra phanitli won kapha wonri, iram kaphungli yarshungwon."
"Longshim ngalanao mayarnao saikora, ningkashak tui la ngaroksa."
"Chitharan leikashi thot khangatei lei, ringkaphawui thotna iramli."

English Translation & Meaning:

"At Yarra festival, spring blossoms blanket our mountain hills with radiant splendor."
"Young men and maidens of the dormitory exchange poetic songs of mutual esteem and affection."
"In this season of spring awakening, true love flourishes and unites our generation."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Convening of youth cohorts within the Mayarshim (boys) and Ngashim (girls) dormitories.
2. Traditional courting exchanges: Young men present flowers and firewood; young women prepare delicacies.
3. Singing of Yarra Laa (spring awakening chants) across the village grounds.
4. Athletic games, rope-pulling, and social banter fostering community cohesion.
5. Formal communal banquet funded through youth collaborative labor projects.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Youth Dormitory Members (Mayarnao and Ngalanao), Dormitory Guardians

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